
This act summary is provided for the convenience of the public and members of the General Assembly. It is intended to provide a general summary of the act and may not be exhaustive. It has been prepared by the staff of the Office of Legislative Counsel without input from members of the General Assembly. It is not intended to aid in the interpretation of legislation or to serve as a source of legislative intent.

Act No. 97 (H.940). An act relating to miscellaneous public utility subjects

Subjects: Telecommunications; energy; public service; utilities; energy efficiency; enhanced energy planning

This act has three separate parts. First, it creates a session law provision giving Burlington Electric Department authority to use thermal energy and process fuel funding on additional types of projects for the next three years that otherwise would not be allowed. The funds may be spent on programs for the thermal energy or transportation sectors, including programs to deliver thermal and transportation measures that enable fossil fuel and greenhouse gas emissions reductions, such as geothermal test well funding.

Next, the act makes changes to the process of enhanced energy planning that regional planning commissions and municipalities use. It requires regional planning commissions to submit draft regional plans to the Department of Public Service concurrently with their submission to the Land Use Review Board. It ensures that municipalities do not experience gaps in having an approved energy plan, thereby maintaining their ability to receive substantial deference. It streamlines public feedback by consolidating it with the adoption of broader regional or town plans, rather than conducting separate processes.

The last part abolishes the Telecommunications and Connectivity Advisory Board.

Effective Date: May 13, 2026